

Pulse (by fractionalcto.ai) — Google Ads API Usage & Design Document

Application for Google Ads API Basic Access

Product	Pulse (by fractionalcto.ai) — agentic analytics for small businesses
Business	fractionalcto.ai — a sole proprietorship (owner: Ramandeep Ahuja)
Contact	rahuja@fractionalcto.ai
API access requested	Basic Access (read-only reporting)
Tool type	Internal / client-authorized web application

1. Product overview

Pulse is a web-based business-analytics dashboard and AI assistant for small businesses. A business owner connects the data sources they already use — their Shopify store, Google Analytics 4, Google Ads, and Meta Ads — and Pulse presents a unified view of revenue, traffic, and advertising performance, plus a natural-language assistant that answers questions by running structured queries over that connected data.

Google Ads is one of these optional connectors. When a business links its Google Ads account, Pulse retrieves campaign performance metrics so the owner can see advertising spend and return alongside store revenue and site traffic in a single place, and ask the assistant questions such as “which campaigns had the best return on ad spend last month?”

2. Company and business model

fractionalcto.ai is a sole proprietorship that provides software products for small businesses under a subscription (SaaS) model. Pulse is one of these products. We do not resell advertising, manage ad campaigns on behalf of clients, or provide ad-buying services. Revenue comes solely from software subscriptions paid by the businesses that use the dashboard.

Each customer authorizes access to their own advertising and analytics accounts; Pulse reads that data to generate reports and insights for that same customer. Customers are independent small businesses (for example, e-commerce retailers) who own the Google Ads accounts being reported on.

3. Who uses the tool

- Small-business owners and their team members, who view dashboards and ask the assistant questions about their own connected accounts.
- Access is gated by Google sign-in and per-tenant isolation — each business only ever sees its own data.
- No data is shared across customers, sold, or used for advertising or model training.

4. How Pulse uses the Google Ads API

Pulse uses the Google Ads API in a strictly **read-only** capacity to generate reports. It calls a single reporting method:

- **GoogleAdsService.SearchStream** — to retrieve campaign-level performance metrics segmented by date.

It uses the customer's **login-customer-id** (the authorized manager account) and the linked client customer ID. A representative GAQL query Pulse issues:

```
SELECT segments.date, campaign.name, metrics.cost_micros, metrics.clicks,
       metrics.impressions, metrics.conversions, metrics.conversions_value
FROM campaign
WHERE segments.date BETWEEN '2026-05-01' AND '2026-05-31'
```

The retrieved fields are aggregated into the metrics shown on the dashboard and used by the assistant: ad spend, clicks, impressions, conversions, conversion value, and the derived ratios CTR, CPC, CPA, and ROAS.

5. Mutate operations — none

Pulse does **not** create, edit, pause, or remove campaigns, budgets, bids, keywords, or any other entity. It calls no mutate services. The developer token and all access are used exclusively for read-only reporting on accounts the customer has explicitly authorized.

6. Authentication and authorization

- Customers authorize access through Google's standard OAuth 2.0 consent flow using the <https://www.googleapis.com/auth/adwords> scope.
- Pulse exchanges the resulting refresh token for short-lived access tokens server-side at query time.
- Account linking uses Google Ads' manager-account model: the client account is linked to our manager account and the link is accepted by the client's account administrator.

7. Data handling and security

- All credentials (refresh tokens, developer token, OAuth secrets) are encrypted at rest with AES-256-GCM and decrypted only in server-side code.
- Secrets are never exposed to the browser, never logged, and never committed to source control.
- Customer data is isolated per tenant using row-level security in the database.
- Retrieved Google Ads metrics are used only to render that customer's own reports and assistant answers — never shared, sold, or used for model training.

8. Data flow

1) Customer connects Google Ads via OAuth → 2) Pulse stores the encrypted refresh token → 3) When the customer views the dashboard or asks the assistant a question, the Pulse server exchanges the refresh token for an access token → 4) Pulse issues a read-only SearchStream query for the selected date range → 5) results are aggregated into metrics and charts shown only to that

customer.

9. Expected API call volume

Low. Calls are made on-demand when a customer loads their dashboard or asks the assistant a question, scoped to a single account and date range, with short-term caching. We expect well within Basic Access limits for our current small-business customer base.

10. User interface

The dashboard presents Google Ads metrics (Ad spend, Conversions, ROAS, CPA) as summary cards with period-over-period change, plus a campaign-performance table ranked by spend. The assistant answers advertising questions in plain language, always citing figures pulled from the API rather than estimates. Live screenshots of the running product are available on request.

This tool requests read-only Basic Access for reporting purposes only and complies with the Google Ads API Terms of Service and Required Minimum Functionality for reporting tools.